

Level Up.

The 6-Week Intermediate Plan

A 6-week strength and functional training program for athletes who have the basics down and are ready to push. Strength days, functional movement days, and progressive overload built in every week.

6	4	5–6	Strength + Functional
WEEK PROGRAM	DAYS/WEEK	REST BETWEEN SETS	APPROACH

WHO THIS IS FOR

You know how to train. Now train with purpose.

This plan is for people who have completed a beginner program or who already train consistently but want a structured system with real progression. Four days per week. Two strength days, two functional days.

Each week builds on the last. By week 6 you will be lifting heavier, moving more athletically, and training with a level of focus and efficiency that most people never develop.

— Experience required

You should be comfortable with basic dumbbell and barbell movements before starting.

— Time commitment

4 days per week. Strength days ~60 minutes. Functional days ~45 minutes.

— Equipment

Dumbbells, barbell, cable machine, bench. Full commercial gym recommended.

— Progression

Increase weight by 5–10% or decrease rest time each week. Track everything.

THE STRUCTURE

How the program is built.

WEEKS 1-2

Foundation Phase

Reinforce movement patterns. Establish baseline. Build mind-muscle connection.

WEEKS 3-4

Progression Phase

Increase weight. Reduce rest. More challenging functional movements.

WEEKS 5-6

Peak Phase

Push intensity. Challenge strength limits. Improve athletic performance.

Universal Warm-Up & Cool-Down

Perform before and after every session — 5 minutes each. Each movement 20–30 seconds.

MOVEMENT	MOVEMENT	TARGET MUSCLES
Arm Swings	Forward Fold Stretch	Hamstrings, Lower Back
Torso Twists	Deep Lunge Stretch each side	Hips, Glutes, Quads
Hip Openers	Overhead Tricep Stretch	Triceps, Shoulders
Leg Swings	Seated Hamstring Stretch	Hamstrings, Glutes
Jog in Place or Jump Rope	Box Breathing	Cardiovascular

Weeks 1 & 2 — Foundation Phase

Reinforce form. Establish baseline. Build consistency.

Day 1 — Upper Strength

Tip: Slow eccentrics on every pressing movement. Form over weight.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
DB Bench Press	4x6–8	Build upper body pressing strength and control.
Bent Over Rows	3x6–8	Develop back thickness and overall pulling strength.
DB Shoulder Press	3x8–10	Increase shoulder mass and overhead pressing strength.
Lat Pull Downs	3x10–12	Improve lat strength and develop back width.
DB Lateral Raise	3x12–15	Isolate lateral deltoids for balanced shoulder development.
Tricep Dips superset DB Curls	3x12 each	Balanced arm work. Control both movements.

Day 2 — Lower Strength & Core

Tip: Keep upright posture. Drive through heels on squats and deadlifts.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Leg Extension	3x10–12	Focus on quad isolation and knee stability.
Leg Curls	3x10–12	Strengthen hamstrings and promote posterior chain development.
Barbell Squat	4x6–8	Build lower body power with a focus on form and control.
Romanian Deadlifts	4x8	Improve posterior chain strength and mobility.
Walking Lunge	2x10/leg	Build unilateral leg strength and improve balance.

Planks	3x45–60 sec	Enhance core stability to support heavy compound lifts.
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Day 3 — Upper Body Functional

Tip: Control each rep. Avoid momentum. Feel the muscle.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Push-Ups	3x10–12	Activate chest, triceps, and shoulders with full-body tension.
Close Grip Pull Downs	3x8–10	Build back width and improve pulling power.
DB Incline Bench	4x8–10	Target upper chest development and shoulder stability.
Single Arm DB Row	3x10–12	Improve unilateral back strength and posture.
DB Lateral Raise	3x12–15	Isolate deltoids for balanced shoulder development.
DB Curls superset Tricep Dips	2x12 each	High-rep arm finisher. Control throughout.

Day 4 — Lower Body Functional

Tip: Focus on explosive power with control. Absorb landings softly.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Box Jumps	3x8–10	Improve explosive power and lower body coordination.
Bulgarian Split Squats	3x8–10/leg	Strengthen quads and glutes. Improve single-leg stability.
Jump Squats	3x12–15	Enhance power and explosiveness in lower body movements.
DB Step Ups	3x10/leg	Focus on unilateral strength and functional movement.
Lateral Lunge	3x10/side	Improve lateral strength and hip mobility.
Russian Twist	3x20	Engage core and improve rotational strength.

Weeks 3 & 4 — Progression Phase

Increase weight 5–10% where possible. Reduce rest by 10–15 seconds.

Day 1 — Upper Strength (Wk 3–4)

Tip: Push heavier. Same movement quality — no compromise on form.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
DB Bench Press	4x6–8	Continue building pressing strength. Heavier with same control.
Bent Over Rows	3x6–8	Increase load on pulling movements for back thickness.
DB Shoulder Press	3x8–10	Build shoulder mass and pressing power.
Seated Rows	3x12–15	Increase back thickness and improve posture.

DB Shrugs	3x20	Build trap strength and stability for upper back.
Tricep Dips superset DB Curls	3x12 each	High reps to fatigue the arms and improve endurance.

Day 2 — Lower Strength & Core (Wk 3–4)

Tip: Drive through heels. Keep chest up. Engage glutes.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Leg Extension	3x10–12	Isolate quads for better knee stability.
Leg Curls	3x10–12	Strengthen hamstrings and posterior chain.
Barbell Squat	4x6–8	Increase lower body strength with full-range squatting.
Romanian Deadlifts	4x8	Target posterior chain. Focus on hamstrings and glutes.
Walking Lunge	2x10/leg	Improve unilateral leg strength and balance.
Planks	3x45–60 sec	Maintain core strength for heavy compound movements.

Day 3 — Upper Functional (Wk 3–4)

Tip: Strict form. Avoid momentum on all pulling movements.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Push-Ups	3x10–12	Activate upper body with full tension maintained throughout.
Close Grip Pull Downs	3x8–10	Build back width and strength through controlled pulling.
DB Incline Bench	4x8–10	Strengthen upper chest and improve shoulder stability.
Single Arm DB Row	3x10–12	Increase unilateral strength for better posture.
DB Lateral Raise	3x12–15	Develop lateral deltoid for broader shoulders.
DB Curls superset Tricep Dips	2x12 each	Balanced arm development with high-rep finishing work.

Day 4 — Lower Functional (Wk 3–4)

Tip: Explosive with control. Engage core throughout.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Heel Elevated Squats	3x10–12	Target quads with greater knee flexion.
Leg Curls	3x10–12	Strengthen posterior chain and promote knee stability.
Reverse Lunge	3x8–10/leg	Increase single-leg strength and stability.
Box Jumps	3x10–12	Build explosive power through lower body.
Lateral Lunge	3x10/leg	Increase lateral strength and enhance hip mobility.
Hanging Leg Raise	3x8–10	Focus on lower abs and core control.

Weeks 5 & 6 — Peak Phase

Push your limits. Aim for personal bests while keeping technique intact.

Day 1 — Upper Strength (Wk 5–6)

Tip: Challenge yourself. Same quality, heavier load.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
DB Bench Press	4x6–8	Build upper body pressing strength — push heavier than previous weeks.
Bent Over Rows	3x6–8	Focus on strength and control to continue developing back thickness.
DB Shoulder Press	3x8–10	Strengthen shoulders for greater pressing power and stability.
Reverse Grip Pull Downs	3x10–11	Target lats and biceps for increased back width.
DB Arnold Press	3x8–10	Fully activate all three deltoid heads for complete shoulder development.
Tricep Dips superset DB Curls	3x12 each	High reps for arm and shoulder endurance.

Day 2 — Lower Strength & Core (Wk 5–6)

Tip: Drive through heels. Core tight on every rep.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Barbell Squat	4x6–8	Build lower-body strength and power. Push heavier with clean form.
Romanian Deadlifts	4x8	Focus on posterior chain. Develop hamstrings and glutes.
Leg Extension	3x10–12	Isolate quads for improved knee strength and stability.
Leg Curls	3x12–15	Strengthen hamstrings with slow, controlled movements.
Calf Raise	3x15–20	Build calf endurance and strength for better leg balance.
Russian Twist	3x15/side	Improve rotational core strength for athletic performance.

Day 3 — Upper Functional (Wk 5–6)

Tip: Dynamic movements with strict form to optimize muscle engagement.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Pull-Ups	3x5–8	Build upper back strength and improve pulling power.
DB Flat Bench	3x8–10	Strengthen the chest and triceps with controlled pressing.
Chest Supported DB Row	3x10–12	Isolate the back for increased muscle definition.

DB Incline Bench	3x12–15	Focus on upper chest activation and shoulder stability.
Bend Over DB Rows	3x10–12	Strengthen back muscles and improve posture.
DB Lateral Raise	3x12–15	Develop lateral deltoid for balanced shoulder definition.

Day 4 — Lower Functional (Wk 5–6)

Tip: Stay explosive and controlled. Core engaged throughout.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	GOAL
Bodyweight Squats	4x10–12	Activate lower body and improve mobility.
Walking Lunges	3x8–10/leg	Build single-leg strength and stability.
Box Jumps	3x10–12	Improve explosive power and overall athletic performance.
Leg Curl	3x12–15	Target hamstrings with slow controlled movements.
Leg Extension	3x12–15	Isolate quads for better knee stability and muscle growth.
Hanging Leg Raise	2x10–12	Strengthen lower abs and hip flexors with strict form.

A NOTE FROM COACH TYLER

Intermediate means you're dangerous — if you stay consistent.

Six weeks of structured progressive training is where real change happens. Not the first week. Not the last. The middle — when it's hard, when you're sore, and when you show up anyway.

Track your weights. Beat them next week. That's the whole game.

When you're ready to step up to the advanced program or combine this with running — that's what 1-on-1 coaching is built for.

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